

siblings, spouse, you—are there as her support team. Put someone in charge of recording the price of everything your daughter puts into the cart; have them keep a running tally on a big yellow legal pad. Have someone else provide color commentary, suggesting strategies when your daughter gets stuck. “The name-brand flour costs \$6.99, or you could get the same size of the store brand for only \$4.99.” Be sure to give her a warning when she’s within \$10 of her target, and another warning when she’s within \$5. And don’t forget to leave her a cushion for tax and to explain what that is! Set a family goal: to have a great meal and not go over budget no matter what.

Maybe your daughter sees a bakery cake that she really, *really* wants, or a piece of her favorite candy in the checkout line. It’s your job to keep her on task. Explain that getting that cake or that piece of candy means *not* getting the ingredients you need for dinner; you’d actually have to take something out of the cart and put it back on the shelf. Teach the lesson that getting what she wants means depriving the family of something it needs. It may sound harsh, but she needs to understand that good money management means making sacrifices.

Make dinner as a family and enjoy the fruits of your labor. And don’t forget to make the annual contribution of \$100 to her Meanie Money Bin. After today, she’ll appreciate that gift all the more.

Age 8

Bring-Your-Child-to-Work Day

This year, you’re going to plan something special in addition to the \$100 gift. The night before your child’s eighth birthday, help her lay out her clothes for the next day. Mutually agree on a morning ritual—a quick breakfast, maybe, or fresh-pressed waffles if you’ve got the time. The next morning, pour her a glass of chocolate milk while you have your coffee. You’ll both benefit from a little extra kick, because today is bring-your-son-or-daughter-to-work day.

This is an important day in your child’s life. Sure, there’s the official “take-your-kid-to-work day,” but I took, my son, Trevor, to